

FIGMA

CONTENTS

▶ 1 • Colour – as variables, not styles	1
Primitive group – same in every mode	2
Semantic group – aliases that change per mode	3
▶ 2 • Type	4
▶ 3 • Spacing variables	5
▶ 4 • Effects	5
▶ 5 • The three patterns	6
▶ 6 • Dev Mode	6
▶ 7 • Checklist	7

SEC.01

1 • COLOUR – AS VARIABLES, NOT STYLES

Use **variables** (not paint styles) so the ink/bone/pink fields switch as modes.

Create a collection **Riposte** with three modes: **Bone**, **Ink**, **Pink**.

PRIMITIVE GROUP – SAME IN EVERY MODE

VARIABLE	HEX
base/ink	#1D1A17
base/ink-raised	#241F1B
base/ink-head	#2B2723
base/ink-line	#5C554C
base/bone	#F6F1E7
base/bone-dim	#EAE4D6
base/white	#FFFFFF
accent/pink	#F0477D
accent/orange	#FE9A0D
accent/teal	#12B795
accent/pink-deep	#D81150
accent/orange-deep	#A15E01
accent/teal-deep	#0C7A63
accent/teal-ink	#04463A

SEMANTIC GROUP – ALIASES THAT CHANGE PER MODE

VARIABLE	BONE	INK	PINK
bg	bone	ink	pink
surface	bone	ink-raised	pink
surface-sunken	bone-dim	ink-head	ink
text	ink	bone	bone
line	ink	bone	bone
line-dashed	ink	ink-line	bone
accent	pink	teal	orange
accent-text	pink-deep	teal	ink
label-fill	ink	teal	ink
label-ink	bone	bone	bone

Bind every component to the **semantic** group. Then a frame set to the Ink mode inverts the whole tree for free – same behaviour as `data-theme="dark"` in CSS.

Faster start: install any "ASE / palette import" plugin and load `../palettes/riposte.ase` to get the 14 primitives, then build the semantic aliases by hand.

SEC.02

2 • TYPE

Install **JetBrains Mono** locally (or add it as a shared font on an Org plan). Weights 400 / 700 / 800 only.

Figma letter-spacing accepts `em` directly – use the CSS values as-is:

STYLE	FONT	SIZE	WEIGHT	CASE	SPACING	LINE HEIGHT
Display	JetBrains Mono	74	800	UPPER	-1%	102%
H1	JetBrains Mono	54	700	UPPER	3%	115%
H2	JetBrains Mono	40	700	UPPER	3%	115%
H3	JetBrains Mono	30	700	UPPER	3%	115%
Lead	JetBrains Mono	19	700	–	0	155%
Body	JetBrains Mono	15	400	–	0	155%
Body SM	JetBrains Mono	14	400	–	0	155%
Nav	JetBrains Mono	12	700	UPPER	8%	120%
Label	JetBrains Mono	11	700	UPPER	10%	120%
Tag	JetBrains Mono	11	700	UPPER	14%	120%
Spec	JetBrains Mono	11	700	UPPER	16%	120%
Kicker	JetBrains Mono	11	700	UPPER	30%	120%

Set case via **Text → Case → Uppercase**, not by typing caps – it exports as `text-transform` and keeps the source text searchable.

The heading sizes above are the `clamp()` **maxima**. For mobile frames use the minima: display 30, h1 30, h2 24, h3 20.

SEC.03

3 • SPACING VARIABLES

Number variables in a space group: 1:4 2:8 3:12 4:16 5:24 6:34 7:48 8:64 9:72.

Auto-layout defaults: gap 34, padding 16, section padding-block 64.

Layout grids – stretch, 4vw-equivalent margins:

FRAME	COLUMNS	GUTTER	MARGIN
Desktop 1440	12	34	190 (→ 1060 content)
Tablet 768	6	34	31
Mobile 390	4	16	16

SEC.04

4 • EFFECTS

- ▶ **Corner radius 0 on everything.** Set it in the component defaults so nobody has to remember.
- ▶ **Drop shadows:** X 4, Y 4, Blur 0, Spread 0, colour accent/pink or accent/teal. Blur must be 0 – this is the single most-broken rule when people work in Figma, because Figma's default shadow has a blur of 4.
- ▶ Big CTAs stack two: 4,4,0 teal and 8,8,0 pink (scaled from the CSS 8/16).
- ▶ Hover state: translate(-2px,-2px) + the offset shadow + inverted fill.

SEC.05

5 • THE THREE PATTERNS

Figma has no conic gradient. Build each once as a component:

- ▶ **Checker** – 22px squares in a 2×2 alternating block, tiled to a 26px-tall strip with 2px ink rules top and bottom.
- ▶ **Harlequin** – 34px squares rotated 45°, alternating pink / teal, 38px band.
- ▶ **Tri-band** – linear gradient at 105° with hard stops: pink 0–36%, orange 36–64%, teal 64–100%. Place paired stops at each boundary so Figma doesn't interpolate.

SEC.06

6 • DEV MODE

Variable names map straight to the CSS custom properties – base/ink → -ink, accent/pink-deep → -pink-deep, space/6 → -space-6. Developers should be consuming `../brand/riposte-brand.css` directly rather than copying values out of Dev Mode.

SEC.07

7 • CHECKLIST

- ☐ Variables, not styles; three modes wired
- ☐ Components bound to semantic aliases, not primitives
- ☐ Radius 0 in component defaults
- ☐ Every shadow has blur 0
- ☐ Case set via Text → Case, not typed
- ☐ JetBrains Mono at 400/700/800 only

SOURCE tools/figma.md SHA a24b7eeb0ad7 BUILT 2026-08-24